

# TUBE-CRESTED MUNCHER

## PARASAUROLOPHUS

**With its extravagant crest and beak,** this herbivore belongs to a family of plant-eating dinosaurs called hadrosaurs. Paleontologists think that *Parasaurolophus*'s unusual tubelike crest, made of lightweight snout bones, may have helped amplify its call. A narrow beak meant *Parasaurolophus* was probably a picky eater, capable of rearing up on its hind legs to pick vegetation off taller trees. Like other hadrosaurs, it may have been able to walk on its hind limbs. It's possible *Parasaurolophus* used this ability to make itself look bigger when under threat from smaller predators.

The hadrosaur's toothless beak helped it crop vegetation with ease.

*Parasaurolophus* used its cheek muscles to keep food in its mouth while it chewed.

**LONGEST  
CREST**

### AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 31 ft (9.5 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 76.5–73 MYA
- **HABITAT** Dense forests

